LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 32 · October 20, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Bekhorot 32 continues פרק כל פסולי המקדשין — tracking down the מקור of the prohibition on selling maaser behemah: a גזירה שוה of לא יגאל between מעשר and חרמים, Rava's אם אינו ענין, and Rav Ashi's plain reading (לא יגאל means לא ימכר). The daf also refines הבלאה (bundling) workarounds — orphans' maaser sold כדרכו, adults' via hide, bones, and horns — and closes with the משנה on who may eat a בכור בעל מום: Beit Shammai says kohanim only, Beit Hillel and Rabbi Akiva say even non-Jews.

שכר שבת · THE CHAZZAN'S SELICHOS INVOICE



1. You can't be paid for Shabbos work (שכר שבת), but you can get paid בהבלאה — bundled with weekday work. Lebowitz traces the chazzan's minhag to exactly this: bill for the one weeknight of selichos, and the whole Yamim Noraim comes along for free.

“he charges a lot of money for that first night of סליחות, and then he does יום כיפור and ראש השנה for free, so to speak.”

— Rabbi Lebowitz

קידושין · PROPOSING WITH THE HOST'S FOOD



2. Rabbi Akiva lets b'chor meat be served even to a non-Jew — serving doesn't remove its kedushah, but selling does. Elefant spins off: if a guest's food still belongs to the host, could the guest grab his host's dinner and propose to a woman with it?

“he takes that food and he uses it to be מקדש an אשה... If somebody is giving the כלה a ring, the question that we ask the חתן is: does that ring belong to you?”

— Rabbi Elefant

שביעית · SELLING THE BOTTLE, NOT THE WINE



3. Borrowing הבלאה logic from tevilat keilim (you buy the contents, the vessel is incidental), some suggest selling shmita wine by 'selling' the bottle with the wine along for the ride. Lebowitz delivers the poskim's verdict.

“you're not buying the wine, you're just buying the כלי, and the wine comes along with it. So, most of the פוסקים say, come on, that's ridiculous.”

— Rabbi Lebowitz

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הבלאה · THE FIVE-CENT ESROG



4. The Gemara's חילוק: bundling a shvi'is esrog is invisible because an esrog barely moves the price — unlike maaser-behemah meat, which is obviously the whole deal. Lebowitz notes the Gemara's economics have not aged well.

“an אתרוג cost five cents, it doesn't cost anything... Obviously market conditions have changed in our generation, and the אתרוגים can command quite a quite quite a price.”

— Rabbi Lebowitz